
When I graduated, I tried desperately to get coffee with every person who I'd worked with in the hopes that they'd hire me back. They met with me, and it was awkward because it was clear what I wanted. There was no immediate job offer as a result of having interned at *The Daily Show*. Now, do I know for sure that the job I later landed at the *Huffington Post* after graduation wasn't offered to me because it said "Comedy Central" on my résumé? I don't know. I'm not sure how much it made my résumé stand out. So could it have been the best thing I ever did and I'll never know because I wasn't in the room for hiring decisions? Sure.

When you're young and broke and trying to carve your way in the world, every opportunity seems like it's do-or-die. Looking back, I'm not sure how I could have convinced younger me that older me didn't really *need* to work for *The Daily Show*.

And in my new-age spirit, I don't want to discredit any experiences I had that led me to this point. If I hadn't cried about money on that New York sidewalk, would I have made the financial podcast that led to this book? It's maybe naive to think, "It's all leading somewhere," in that "wherever you are is where you're meant to be" destiny way. But it's hard to escape my hippie roots.

SHOULD YOU DO AN UNPAID INTERNSHIP?

Not all companies are shitty about internships. It's easy to find out who with just a little Internet sleuthing at places like Sterne's website and others.

Carolyn D'Anna is the head of human resources at CohnReznick, which was listed as #3 on CNBC's 2017 list of top ten places to intern. The company pays interns \$23 per hour, according to Glassdoor (which also provides transparency for salaries).

The reason the public accounting firm offers a paid internship, she said, is that CohnReznick is going to be directly making money off those interns because they are billing clients by the hour and interns spend time working with those same clients. They believe interns should get a cut of that billed time. But